

and AI Super Resolution for boosted graphics worked well during my time testing the phone.

However, pushing the hardware to its limits revealed a tendency to heat up significantly during intensive tasks, with temperatures reaching 45-49 degrees Celsius during 3D Mark Wild Life stress tests. Thankfully, real-world gaming scenarios were far less taxing, with the phone only getting mildly warm after extended sessions.

The GT 7 Pro's thermal management system, while not flawless, does a commendable job of balancing performance and heat during everyday use. The inclusion of LPDDR5X RAM and UFS 4.0 storage ensures lightning-fast app launches and seamless multitasking. However, the choice of a USB 2.0 port feels like a glaring oversight in a device that otherwise screams cutting-edge in terms of performance.

SOFTWARE AND AI FEATURES

Running on Android 15 with Realme UI 6.0, the Realme GT 7 Pro offers a polished software experience. The UI is fluid and packed with features, and it closely resembles ColorOS in both appearance and functionality.

The company promises three years of OS updates and four years of security patches, which feels underwhelming when compared to competitors offering more extended software support.

Realme has also leaned heavily into AI with this device. Features like AI Ultra Clarity, Sketch to Image, and the upcoming AI Motion Deblur don't necessarily revolutionise how we use our phones, but they're a good bit of fun.

In our AI benchmark tests, the phone achieved a respectable Digit AI-Q score of 65/100, indicating its capability to handle advanced AI workloads. However, while these features are impressive on paper, their real-world utility remains somewhat niche.

CAMERAS

The Realme GT 7 Pro's camera setup is a mixed bag. While the 50 MP primary and 3x telephoto lenses deliver commend-



able results in good lighting, the 8 MP ultrawide camera falls short of expectations for a phone in this price range.

Daylight shots from the primary camera exhibit vibrant colours and decent dynamic range, while the telephoto lens provides sharp and detailed zoom shots up to 6x.

Portrait photography is solid, with good subject separation, but edge detection could be more accurate. Low-light performance, however, leaves much to be desired, with noticeable noise and a decline in sharpness.

The ultrawide lens performs poorly in indoor and low-light conditions, producing lacklustre images that fail to justify its inclusion.

The 16 MP selfie camera performs adequately in well-lit environments but struggles with noise in dim lighting.

Video capabilities extend up to 8K at 24 fps, though the footage is jittery and lacks stability. Switching to 4K at 60 fps yields better results, with smoother footage and more balanced dynamic range. Overall, while the Realme GT 7 Pro's cameras are competent, they don't quite measure up to the standards set by its performance and display.

BATTERY LIFE

One of the most significant controversies surrounding the Realme GT 7 Pro's release is its battery capacity. The Indian variant features a 5,800 mAh cell, a noticeable downgrade from the 6,500 mAh battery in the Chinese model.

Our review unit, frustratingly equipped with the 6,500 mAh battery,

provided impressive endurance, lasting a day and a half of moderate usage. However, with the smaller capacity in the Indian version, users can realistically expect just about a day of usage.

Charging speeds are stellar, with the 120 W charger included in the box taking the larger 6,500 mAh battery from 0 to 100% in just 36 minutes. Unfortunately, the absence of wireless charging feels like a missed opportunity in a flagship-class device. Despite its fast-charging prowess, the reduced battery size in the Indian variant could be a dealbreaker for heavy users.

VERDICT

The Realme GT 7 Pro sets a high bar for performance, offering unparalleled speed and fluidity in its segment. With its cutting-edge Snapdragon 8 Elite chipset, stunning display, and impressive gaming capabilities, it lives up to its reputation as a flagship killer. However, the compromises in design, thermal management, and camera quality prevent it from being a flawless offering. The reduced battery capacity in the Indian variant further adds to the list of concerns.

At an expected price of ₹60,000–₹65,000, the Realme GT 7 Pro offers incredible value for power users and gamers who prioritize performance above all else. If Realme can address some of the issues through software updates and aggressive pricing, this phone could very well dominate the flagship-killer segment in 2024. For now, it stands as a speed demon that delivers exceptional performance but leaves room for improvement in other areas.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 8 Elite | OS: Android 15, Realme UI 6.0 | RAM: 12/16 GB | Storage: 256/512 GB | Display: 6.78" LTPO AMOLED, 1264 x 2780 pixels | Display refresh rate: 120 Hz | Cameras: 50 MP + 50 MP + 8 MP | Selfie camera: 16 MP | IP Rating: IP68/IP69 | Battery: 5,800 mAh | Charging: 120 W

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